

Ergodic Theory PhD Exam, May 2012

Do all problems.

Notation: • The statement that $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu, f)$ is a mpt (measure preserving transformation) means that X is a set with the probability measure μ defined on the σ -algebra $\mathcal{B}$ and f is a bijective, bi-measurable map $f : X \rightarrow X$ which preserves the measure μ . • The statement that $(X, d, \mathcal{B}, \mu, f)$ is a mph (measure preserving homeomorphism) means that $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu, f)$ is a mpt and in addition, (X, d) is a compact metric space, f is a homeomorphism, and $\mathcal{B}$ is the Borel σ -algebra.

1. Let (X, d) be a compact metric space and $f : X \rightarrow X$ a homeomorphism.
 - (a) Define the recurrent set $\Lambda(f)$ and the nonwandering set $\Omega(f)$ and show they are both compact, invariant sets.
 - (b) Show that $\Lambda(f) \subset \Omega(f)$ and give an example where the inclusion is proper.
 - (c) Define the omega-limit set $\omega(x, f)$ of a point $x \in X$ and show it is a compact, invariant set.
 - (d) Prove or disprove: For every $x \in X$, that $\omega(x, f) \subset \Lambda(f)$.
2. Let (X, d) be a compact metric space and $f : X \rightarrow X$ a homeomorphism.
 - (a) Show that there is always an f -invariant subset $Z \subset X$ so that f restricted to Z is minimal.
 - (b) Show that there is always a measure μ so that $(X, d, \mathcal{B}, \mu, f)$ is a mph.
3. Assume $(X, d, \mathcal{B}, \mu, f)$ is a mph.
 - (a) Define the support, $\text{supp}(\mu)$, of the measure μ and show it is a compact, invariant set.
 - (b) Show that almost every point in $\text{supp}(\mu)$ is recurrent.
 - (c) Show that every point in $\text{supp}(\mu)$ is nonwandering.
 - (d) Show that $\mu(\Omega(f)) = 1$.
 - (e) If $(X, d, \mathcal{B}, \mu, f)$ is ergodic, show that f is full orbit transitive on $\text{supp}(\mu)$.
 - (f) Show that $\text{supp}(\mu) \subset \Lambda(f)$, where $\Lambda(f)$ is the recurrent set of f .
4. State carefully with complete hypothesis.
 - (a) Birkhoff's pointwise ergodic theorem
 - (b) von Neumann's L^2 -mean ergodic theorem
5. Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

- (a) Define the one-sided subshift of finite type Σ_A^+ determined by A and the shift map $\sigma : \Sigma_A^+ \rightarrow \Sigma_A^+$.
- (b) Define one of the standard metrics on Σ_A^+ .
- (c) Show that periodic points of σ are dense in Σ_A^+ .
- (d) Show that (Σ_A^+, σ) is forward orbit transitive.

- (e) Let N_k be the number of fixed points of σ^k in Σ_A^+ . Compute explicitly

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\log(N_k)}{k}$$

and justify your answer completely.

6. Fix a p with $0 < p < 1$.

- (a) Define the Bernoulli measure μ_p on the two-sided shift on two symbols Σ_2 .
- (b) Show that $(\Sigma_2, \mathcal{B}, \sigma, \mu_p)$ is strong mixing (you don't have to prove it is a mpt, you may assume that is true).
- (c) Define $\alpha : \Sigma_2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$\alpha(\dots s_{-1}s_0s_1s_2\dots) = 2s_{-1} - s_0 + s_2^2.$$

Compute the following limit for μ_p -almost every sequence $\underline{s} \in \Sigma_2$:

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} \alpha(\sigma^i(\underline{s})).$$

and justify your answer completely.

7. Let $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be defined by $f(x, y) = (3x, (1/2)y)$.

- (a) Show that the origin is an unstable fixed point for f .
- (b) Find an invariant, Borel probability measure for f (Hint: don't try too hard).
- (c) Show that your invariant measure in (b) is the only invariant, Borel probability measure.